

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Lunges, retreats in US-Canada feud

New tariff threats traded over border, then pulled back

By Josh Boak, Rob Gillies and Michelle Price
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump’s threat on Tuesday to double his planned tariffs on steel and aluminum from 25% to 50% for Canada led the provincial government of Ontario to suspend its planned surcharges on electricity sold to the United States.

As a result, the White House trade adviser Peter Navarro said the U.S. president pulled back on his doubling of steel and aluminum tariffs, even as the federal government still plans to place a 25% tariff on all steel and aluminum imports starting Wednesday.

The drama on Tuesday delivered a win for Trump but also amplified concerns about tariffs that have roiled the stock market

and stirred recession risks. Tuesday’s escalation and cooling in the ongoing trade war between the United States and Canada only compounded the rising sense of uncertainty of how Trump’s tariff hikes will affect the economies of both countries.

Trump shocked markets Tuesday morning by saying that the increase of the tariffs set to take effect on Wednesday had been a

response to the 25% price hike that Ontario put on electricity sold to the United States.

“I have instructed my Secretary of Commerce to add an ADDITIONAL 25% Tariff, to 50%, on all STEEL and ALUMINUM COMING INTO THE UNITED STATES FROM CANADA, ONE OF THE HIGHEST TARIFFING NATIONS ANYWHERE IN THE WORLD,” Trump posted on Truth Social.

Ontario Premier Doug Ford said on Tuesday afternoon that

U.S. Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick called him and Ford agreed to remove the surcharge. He said he was confident that the U.S. president would also stand down on his own plans for 50% tariffs on Canadian steel and aluminum.

“He has to bounce it off the president but I’m pretty confident he will pull back,” Ford said on Trump’s steel and aluminum tariff threat. “By no means are we just going to roll over. What

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Aisha Wade-Bey presides over her fourth grade class during a math session at Richard Oglesby School on March 7. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

Evaluation system alleged to target Black educators

They have left CPS at higher rates than any other demographic, according to district data

By Ikram Mohamed
Chicago Tribune

After a career as a chef, Gloria Simpson knew she wanted to teach, and when she got the opportunity in 2002, she jumped at the chance to pursue her dream.

Simpson spent 15 years as a culinary teacher in Chicago Public Schools until 2017, when she was forced into retirement, she said, after receiving a poor teaching evaluation. Simpson’s career came to an abrupt end due to what she called “principal manipulation.”

“They used the REACH system to manipulate my rating, which lowered my rating (and) took away my seniority and allowed them to dismiss me over the other person,” Simpson said of the school, which she declined to name.

For more than a decade, Black teachers have left the district at higher rates than any other demographic, according to CPS data. Black teachers now represent 20.6% of the district’s teaching staff, while Black students made up just over 34% of CPS enrollment.

The Chicago Teachers Union

and several educators attribute the decline in part to CPS’ teacher evaluation system known as Recognizing Educators Advancing Chicago’s Students, or REACH.

Since REACH was implemented in 2012, the number of Black teachers has dropped by 10%, according to CPS data.

The decline has profound effects on not only CPS students but also the Black teachers who continue teaching in the district despite being subject to what they say is unfair scrutiny and discipline, according to several educators and union officials

who spoke with the Tribune.

Simpson said that after a decade of teaching, she and the new principal at her school in Austin clashed and the principal manipulated her REACH rating to revoke her seniority and eventually fire her. When she filed an appeal in 2017, Simpson said she eventually won her case. But at that point, it was too late. She had already retired.

“The whole REACH system is too easily manipulated by administrators to do what they want to do,” Simpson said. “Once the

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Rancor among staff led to COPA chief’s exit

Documents show persistent complaints and oversight concerns

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

Rancor among the staff at the Civilian Office of Police Accountability was the driving force behind the recent effort to remove the agency’s former chief administrator, Andrea Kersten, records obtained by the Tribune show.

The Community Commission for Public Safety and Accountability — the city body overseeing the leaders of COPA, the Chicago Police Department and the Police Board — wrote Kersten on Jan. 28 to tell her of a planned no-confidence vote regarding her overseeing COPA.

Persistent complaints and concerns about oversight within COPA, the agency’s workplace culture, the quality of investigations, as well as Kersten’s own public statements and appearances were chief among the reasons highlighted by CCPSA.

“If the police accountability system is or is reasonably perceived to be ineffective or unfair, it will erode public confidence in policing and police oversight,” CCPSA President Anthony Driver and Vice President Remel Terry wrote to Kersten on Jan. 28.

The letter, too, noted several alleged incidents in high-profile COPA cases that only fueled CCPSA’s concerns. Among them, CCPSA claimed that COPA failed to properly document evidence and witness statements in the 2023 investigation of alleged sexual misconduct involving a CPD officer and an underage migrant who was sheltered at the time in a West Side police station.

“Multiple people with first-hand knowledge report that off-the-re-



Kersten

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INSIDE



AUDREY RICHARDSON/TRIBUNE

The upper crust of sandwiches

The 30 best corned beef sandwiches around Chicago, featuring That Jerk at The Corned Beef Hideout. **Food & Health**

MLB returns to the Tokyo Dome

What to know and who to watch in the two-game series between the Cubs and Dodgers on Tuesday and Wednesday. **Chicago Sports**

Army Corps drops plan for expansion of dump

EPA, residents against lakefront project on city’s Southeast Side

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

After yearslong litigation with community groups, staunch opposition from residents and recent resistance from the state environmental agency, the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers announced Tuesday it was dropping a plan to expand a toxic waste dump on the Southeast Side of Chicago.

Over the next two decades, the proposed 25-foot vertical expansion along the Lake Michigan shoreline would have taken in an additional 1 million cubic yards of contaminated sediment dredged from the Calumet River

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A shoreline dump site at the mouth of the Calumet River along Lake Michigan on the Southeast Side on July 18, 2024. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

